INTRODUCTORY SOMMELIER COURSE AND EXAM

AND

CERTIFIED SOMMELIER THEORY EXAM

CURRICULUM GUIDE

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: NEW ZEALAND

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will know the general location, climate, and style of wine produced in New Zealand's most important wine regions.

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will know the specific locations, climates, and principal grape varieties of New Zealand's most important wine regions. A Certified Sommelier will have the ability to describe New Zealand Sauvignon Blanc, the natural factors that are responsible for its distinct style, and be able to recommend and sell food pairings with New Zealand wines to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	Southern Hemisphere Two islands: North Island and South Island 4,100 km/2,500 miles to the southeast of Australia.	
Geography: Climate Categories	**South Island:** Cool Marlborough: Cool maritime (with protection) Central Otago: Cool continental **North Island:** Warmer, humid Hawke's Bay: Moderate maritime	Gisborne: Cool maritime Wairarapa: Cool maritime
Geography: Physical Feature	Southern Alps	
Soil: Type and/or Name	**Gimblett Gravels:** Gravel	
Geography: Appellation	**Geographical Indications (GIs):** trademark only with no minimums, no rules. **New Zealand GI** **North Island GI:** **Hawke's Bay GI** Gimblett Gravels **South Island GI:** **Marlborough GI** **Central Otago GI**	**North Island GI:** **Gisborne GI** **Wairarapa GI** - Martinborough GI **South Island GI:** **Marlborough GI**: - Labeling requires 100% fruit from the region. - Subregions: - Awatere Valley - Wairau Valley **Nelson GI** **Canterbury GI**
Grape Growing	**South Island:** Long sunlight hours **North Island:** Humidity	
Winemaking	Clean, modern, winemaking, use of screwcaps.	
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	Sauvignon Blanc, Chardonnay	Pinot Gris, Gewürztraminer, Riesling (Central Otago)
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	Pinot Noir, Cabernet Sauvignon, Syrah, Merlot	
Wine Law	85% min to list the grape variety on a label.	

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: **NEW ZEALAND**

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Label Terms		
General Terms		
Style	**Whites:** Typically unoaked, high flavor intensity with high natural acidity. **Reds:** Lightly oaked	
Classification		
Producer - Proprietary Brand		Cloudy Bay, Felton Road, Villa Maria
Vintage		Recent vintages are 6 months ahead of Northern Hemisphere.
History & Lore	Young industry, temperance movement, innovation, screwcap initiative.	Know Scott Henry and Vertical Shoot Position (VSP) trellis systems.
Service of Beverage		Know how to open a screwcap.
Food and Beverage Pairing	High-acid and unoaked wines with seafood, starters, salads. Intense flavors can be too much for super delicate dishes.	Sauvignon Blanc has ripeness for sweet-savory ingredients (e.g., mango salsa); pair acid with acid. Pinot Noir and Bordeaux blends can be elegant non-European options.
Business of the Sommelier		

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: AUSTRALIA

Learning Outcome Introductory Sommelier Course: After studying this section, a student will know the general location, climate, and styles of wine produced in Australia's most important wine regions**.**

Learning Outcome Certified Sommelier Exam: After studying this section, a candidate will be know the specific locations, climates, and principal grape varieties of Australia's most important wine regions and the difference between bulk wine regions and premium wine regions. A Certified Sommelier will have the ability to describe Barossa/McLaren Vale Shiraz, recognize iconic producers, and be able to recommend and sell food pairings with Australian wines to a guest.

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Geography: Location	Southern Hemisphere, the size of continental United States.	
Geography: Climate Categories	Hot, dry interior, cooler near coast. Cool maritime to warm Mediterranean to hot and arid.	
Geography: Physical Feature	Elevation in South Australia, currents from Antarctica.	
Soil: Type and/or Name		**Coonawarra:** Terra Rossa
Grape Growing	Concept of blending across regions for volume. 100+ year old vines exist. Irrigation is necessary in the country interior. Best vineyards are near the cooler coast.	
Winemaking	**Traditional:** Blending across regions, American oak **Modern:** Single GI/site, French oak	**Rutherglen:** Fortified wines
Wine: White Grape Variety Names	Riesling, Chardonnay, Sauvignon Blanc/Semillon blend	Semillon (Hunter), Muscat
Wine: Red Grape Variety Names	Shiraz, Grenache, Cabernet Sauvignon	
Wine Law	**GI:** Refers to a geographic place of origin only, no other additional laws. 85% labeling required for grape variety, vintage, and origin.	

INTRODUCTORY & CERTIFIED THEORY CURRICULUM

Subject Name: AUSTRALIA

	Introductory Level	Certified Sommelier Exam
Wine Law / Appellation	**Geographic Indications (GIs)**: Indicates Geographical location only. **Australia, State, Zone, Region, Sub-Region** *More specificity as the region gets smaller. No need to memorize which are Zones vs. Regions but know this system exists. *South Eastern Australia Super GI (high-volume)	
Wine Law / Appellation	New South Wales GI Victoria GI South Australia GI Western Australia GI	Tasmania GI
	South Eastern Australia GI: Riverina GI, Murray Darling GI	**New South Wales GI:** Hunter Valley GI
	Victoria GI: Yarra Valley GI	
	South Australia GI: Barossa Valley GI, McLaren Vale GI, Clare Valley GI, Eden Valley GI	**South Australia GI:** Coonawarra GI
	Western Australia GI: Margaret River GI	
Label Terms		
General Terms	Superzone (South Eastern Australia)	
Style		
Classification		
Producer - Proprietary Brand		Penfold's Grange
Vintages		
History & Lore	First vines planted in 1788 (near Sydney), industry moved west after phylloxera (quarantine), sweet/fortified wines dominated until late 20th Century, purchased French company that invented Stelvin closure, Yellow Tail business model.	
Service of Beverage		Screw cap
Food and Beverage Pairing		Ripe Shiraz with intense grilled or barbecued meat. Use Clare or Eden Riesling like New Zealand Sauvignon Blanc. Yarra Pinot Noir parallels Willamette Valley Pinot Noir. Yarra Chardonnay works like Sonoma Coast Chardonnay. Margaret River Bordeaux blends are elegant like wines from Bordeaux.
Business of the Sommelier		